

Election App — Improvements After Our First Election

Free Reformed Church of Darling Downs — June 2026

We used the election app for the first time at the office bearer election on **7 June 2026**. It worked well. Two things stood out as needing improvement, both raised by members on the day:

1. **The text on the screen was too small** — brothers at the back of the church could not read the results.
2. **Signing the attendance register took too long** — everyone queued for one sheet of paper and one pen.

Both have now been addressed. This document explains what changed, in plain terms. *(All names in the screenshots are fictional.)*

1. The screen is now readable from the back

Three changes were made to what the congregation sees on the projector:

The rule calculations are gone. The screen used to show the Article 6a and 6b workings (the “valid votes ÷ vacancies ÷ 2” arithmetic) for every office. The chairman and secretary read those numbers from their own screen — the congregation does not need them. Removing them freed up a large amount of space.

The “how votes arrived” bar is gone. The bottom strip showing how many votes came in digitally, on paper, or by post served no purpose for the congregation and has been removed.

One office at a time, much larger. Instead of squeezing Elder and Deacon side by side, the screen now shows **one office at a time, using the full width**, and switches to the next office every few seconds (the timing is adjustable). A long candidate list — we can have up to eight Elder candidates — flows into two columns. The result: candidate names and vote counts are roughly **twice as large** as before, and the size adjusts itself so nothing ever falls off the bottom of the screen.

Election of 3 Elders and 1 Deacon

CLOSED

100

100

✓

100 of 100 (100%)

ballots received

brothers participating (98 in-person + 2 postal)

all votes in

Round 2 required

- Elder: 2 vacancies remain

For Elder

Br. Dirk Boersma

38

Br. Hans Bouwmeester

19

Br. Bert Huizenga

46

Br. Frank Jongeling

28

Br. Carl Plug

42

Br. Gerrit Terpstra

24

Br. Adrian Vanderwerf

ELECTED

50

Br. Evert Wagenaar

33

Blank votes

20

Total

300

✓

The Elder results fill the whole screen — eight candidates in two columns.

Election of 3 Elders and 1 Deacon CLOSED				
100	100	✓	100 of 100 (100%)	
ballots received	brothers participating (98 in-person + 2 postal)	all votes in		
Round 2 required - Elder: 2 vacancies remain				
For Deacon				
Br. Istvan Bosman	ELECTED			51
Br. Jeff Eilander				33
Br. Lucas Kempers				5
Br. Koos Maring				9
Blank votes				2
Total				100 ✓

A few seconds later the display switches to the Deacon results.

Everything else works as before: the live ballot counter, the “Round 2 required” notice when a runoff is needed, and the ELECTED markers once results are shown.

2. Sign-in at the door is now much faster

On 7 June, every brother queued for a single attendance register. Two changes fix this — one on paper, one digital. They work together, but each also works on its own.

a) The paper register now prints as several one-page sheets

The attendance register no longer prints as one long list. It automatically splits into **single-page sheets of at most 16 names each**, in alphabetical order, with the surname range printed in large letters at the top of each sheet — so the sheet itself acts as the signpost on the table.

With our current membership that is **7 sheets**. Lay them out across two or three tables, each with its own pen, and brothers find their own sheet and sign — several at once instead of one at a time. One steward can comfortably mind two adjacent sheets.

The signature boxes are also much bigger than before (this was a genuine fault — the rows printed far smaller than intended), and each sheet has a tally line at the bottom so the signatures can be counted per sheet and added up quickly.

Attendance Register — Sheet 1 of 3		
Surnames: Achterberg – Groen		
#	Name	Signature
1	Achterberg, Daniel	
2	Bakker, Ben	
3	Beekman, Sam	
4	Bosch, Aaron	
5	Bouwman, Chris	
6	Cremer, Carl	
7	De Vries, Hank	
8	Dekker, Evan	
9	Dijkstra, Roy	
10	Driessen, Mark	
11	Eikelboom, Tom	
12	Feenstra, Will	
13	Fokkema, Joel	
14	Groen, Gert	

Signatures on this sheet: _____ (count after the doors close, then add up all sheets)

One sheet of the new attendance register (demo list of 40 names, hence 3 sheets).

b) Stewards can check brothers in on their phones (optional)

As a brother arrives and signs, a steward taps his name on a phone. The page is simple: type a few letters of the name, tap, done. A tap can be undone by tapping again. Several stewards can work at the same time — each phone sees the others' taps within a few seconds.

Attendance check-in

Free Reformed Church of Darling Downs —
Election of 3 Elders and 1 Deacon

11
PRESENT

Type a few letters of the name...

Tap a brother as he arrives. Tap again to undo. Other stewards' taps appear automatically.

Achterberg, Daniel ✓

Bakker, Ben ✓

Beekman, Sam ✓

Bosch, Aaron ✓

Bouwman, Chris ✓

Cremer, Carl ✓

De Vries, Hank ✓

Dekker, Evan ✓

Dijkstra, Roy ✓

At the door: tap each brother as he arrives.

Attendance check-in

Free Reformed Church of Darling Downs —
Election of 3 Elders and 1 Deacon

11
PRESENT

terp ✕

Tap a brother as he arrives. Tap again to undo. Other stewards' taps appear automatically.

Terpstra, Albert

Terpstra, Ryan

Type a few letters to find a name instantly.

The benefit comes at the chairman's table: the app shows the **live count of brothers checked in**, and the attendance number — which Article 4 requires and which determines whether candidates reach the required majorities — **fills itself in**. Nobody has to count signatures under time pressure before voting can open.

Election of 3 Elders and 1 Deacon
14 June 2026 - Round 1 of 2
All elections

SETUP

✓ Election details

✓ Members (40)

✓ Offices & Candidates

✓ Election settings

• Codes & printing

ROUND 1

✓ Attendance & postal

✓ Welcome & Rules

✓ Voting

Count & tally

Decide

FINISH

Final results

Minutes & archive

ROUND 1 - ATTENDANCE & POSTAL

Set the attendance count from the register

✓ ATTENDANCE SET (ARTICLE 4)

Count the brothers who have signed the **attendance register** at the door, and enter that number below. This drives the Article 6b threshold, without it, no candidate can be declared elected.

Brothers Present (from attendance register)

98

Save attendance

STEWARD CHECK-IN (LIVE DIGITAL REGISTER)

Stewards at the door open this page on their phones and tap each brother as he arrives — no manual counting. Several stewards can work at once. Brothers still sign the paper register (Article 4); the live count below saves you tallying signatures.

Stewards scan the QR or type:


<http://10.0.0.2/checkin/demotoken>

Checked in so far: 11

Use this count as attendance

POSTAL VOTES (LAST CHANCE)

2 postal votes already entered. Last chance to enter envelopes handed to the chairman just now, postal votes that arrive after voting opens cannot be added.

Add or adjust postal votes

Postal Tally Helper

Next: Welcome & Rules →

The chairman's attendance step: live steward count, and a QR code the stewards scan to open the check-in page.

Stewards get access by scanning a QR code shown on the chairman's screen — they do not need the admin password, and the address is the direct network address that works reliably on phones.

Important: the paper register is still signed exactly as Article 4 requires. The phone check-in only replaces the *counting* of the signatures, not the signatures themselves. And the feature is entirely optional — it can be switched off for any election, in which case the admin simply counts the signatures on the sheets (using the per-sheet tally lines) and types the number in, as before.

What has *not* changed

- How brothers vote (phone with a one-time code, or paper ballot) — unchanged.
- Vote secrecy and the one-vote-per-member safeguards — unchanged.
- The counting, runoff rules (Articles 6a/6b), and results — unchanged. The rule calculations are still applied and still visible to the chairman; they have only been removed from the public screen.
- The printer pack — it simply now contains the new register sheets automatically.

Prepared 10 June 2026. The improvements are installed and were verified with a test election on the church laptop.